

Company: ISS-STOXX

Job Profile: SDE

Offer Type: Internship + Placement

Internship Stipend: 60K

CTC: 12.9L Base + 1.1L (PF + Gratuity) = 14L

Location: Nesco IT Park, Goregaon, Mumbai

Process Date: 05-08-2025, Completely Offline

The most important thing about placement season you need to understand is that there is a large amount of luck involved here. You can increase your chances by practicing as much as possible but in the end you really need good luck. **Only One Time!** 😊

During this company's interview process, I happened to be the last candidate in my panel. The shortlist was announced at 12 PM, yet my interview slot didn't come until 7:30 PM — by then, most other panels had wrapped up, and students were heading home after their HR rounds, while I was still waiting for my very first technical interview. It was a long wait, but as I always say, trust your preparation, stay composed, and carry your confidence with you. Stay positive and persistent. Interview processes can be long and challenging. Maintain a positive attitude and persist through the challenges. Your efforts will pay off. Just keep grinding consistently. **It Will All Be Worth !!**

### **Placement Process:**

A total of 3 rounds were conducted - 1 Online Assessment Round, 1 Tech Interview Round & Finally 1 HR Round. All were conducted on the same day. The CGPA Criteria for SDE was 8.5, later reduced to 8. It was further reduced to 7.5. It may not be the case for next year if they don't want more applicants, so it is preferable to maintain a pointer of 8.5 and above.

#### **1. Resume / CGPA Shortlisting:**

Curate your resume to align closely with the company's job description, emphasising your key strengths. After finalising it, evaluate its ATS compatibility using platforms such as Resume Worded, targeting a score of 65 or higher. The shortlisted candidates for the Online Assessment and Pre-Placement Talk (PPT) were declared on 3rd August 2025 at 7:00 PM.

### **Pre-Placement Talk**

While the process was originally planned to take place offline, it was later shifted to an online format and conducted at 5 PM on 4th August. During the PPT session, make it a point to listen attentively and note down the names and roles of the presenters -- this small detail can prove valuable in later interactions.

Preparing in advance is equally important; gather basic information about the company such as its founding year, current CEO, and tagline. These details are not only potential question topics but also help you make a positive impression by showing genuine interest. Toward the end of the PPT, consider asking well-thought-out questions to demonstrate engagement, though it's not mandatory.

If you prefer, you can reserve your questions for the post-interview phase, where they may carry even greater impact.

## 2. **Online Assessment:** [ Approx. 160 students appeared ]

The online assessment comprised 70 questions to be completed in 90 minutes. It was conducted via Google Forms at the college premises. +1 was given for each correct answer and -0.25 for incorrect ones. We were allowed to use the system calculator. It was invigilated by the company executives.

The assessment covered four major sections: Java (18), Python (17), SQL (5), and Aptitude (30) – Total 70 questions.

The Java and Python sections were largely output-based MCQs, with a strong emphasis on OOPS concepts, errors, exceptions, stacks, queues, and all types of sets in Java. Some questions, such as *“Determine the total number of swaps in the given array using bubble sort”* (with an array provided), were a bit time-consuming. It's advisable to tackle such questions later and prioritize quicker ones first. Make sure you are thoroughly familiar with Java and Python syntax. Since Python was my secondary programming language, I struggled with 2–3 questions due to not knowing the exact syntax.

For SQL Section, queries were asked for the given table and the required output. The queries covered topics like aggregate functions, date functions, subqueries. The questions were on easy to medium level but all the options looked similar at first sight – but had slight differences, making it a bit time-consuming and needing a double check.

I was able to complete the first three sections in 40 minutes, leaving the remaining 50 minutes for the aptitude section.

The Aptitude round consisted of the normal Quantitative Aptitude questions such as Percentages, Ratios, Time-Distance, Boat Upstream-Downstream, Probability, Data Interpretation etc. The questions were on an easy level with few medium ones. The key was to identify and solve questions you are most confident and are well versed with required formulae or logic.

## 3. **Technical Round:** [ 44 students appeared ]

I was the last candidate in my panel, and my panelist was the Associate Director at ISS-STOXX. My interview lasted for about an hour — the only panel to conduct interviews for that long. It began at 7:30 PM, by which time many students had already completed their HR rounds and left. So, if you find yourself waiting outside the TPO for hours, don't panic or stress yourself out.

The interview began with her asking my name. She then went through my resume and asked about my internship, which I had completed during my diploma. She asked me what skills I had acquired during the internship and my overall experience.

Next, she asked what I had prepared for the interview. I mentioned DBMS, OS, SQL, OOPS and also added that I had studied software testing. Be careful whatever you mention will be explored in depth. She then asked for a brief explanation of one of my projects, followed by a few questions on its implementation.

Since I had stated Java as my primary programming language, she asked me a few questions about JDK, JRE, and JVM, and then about how and why Java is considered platform-independent. Make sure you are clear on these basic Java architecture concepts.

The discussion then moved to SQL queries. The first was to find the maximum salary in each department, followed by the query to find the top two salaries in each department. I had to write the queries on paper. She then added *gender* and *city* columns to the same table and asked for the names of female employees with the maximum salary in their respective departments.

Next, the discussion moved to OOP concepts in Java. I was asked to briefly explain the four pillars of OOP. Then, the interviewer presented a few classes — **Shape**, **Rectangle**, **Square**, and **Circle** — and asked me to apply inheritance to them. Initially, I designed Shape as an interface and implemented hierarchical inheritance, where Rectangle, Square, and Circle each implemented the Shape interface. She then encouraged me to think of a more convenient approach. That's when I realized she was expecting multilevel inheritance, such as **Shape** → **Rectangle** → **Square**, since *every Square is a Rectangle*.

Following that, she introduced a Rhombus class and asked me to integrate it into the inheritance tree. Initially unsure, I asked about its properties and understood that, just like *every Square is a Rectangle*, *every Square is also a Rhombus*. I then attempted to inherit Square from both Rectangle and Rhombus, which led to a discussion on the diamond problem in Java, its solutions, and the use of the super keyword.

Then came the DSA questions, the first question was to remove all occurrences of a given key from a linked list. I explained my approach in detail before writing the source code. I fumbled slightly while handling the pointers but kept thinking aloud and explaining my reasoning. I later wrote the correct code and dry-ran it on both the given list and an additional test case to check for edge cases. The second DSA question was straightforward — return true if there are three consecutive odd numbers, else return false.

Finally, I was asked a commonly known puzzle: [Mislabelled Jars](#)

The interview concluded with me asking the panelist about her own experience at ISS-STOXX — current role in the company, and experience in the tech industry.

#### 4. **HR Round:** [ 15 students appeared ]

There were two interviewers in this round — the same ones who had conducted the pre-placement talk. I would advise remembering their names, as interviewers sometimes ask if you know them. I was again the last candidate for the HR round, which lasted about 30–35 minutes and ended around 10 PM.

The conversation began with an introduction about myself and my family background, followed by questions about my 10th-grade percentage, diploma percentage, and current CGPA. My diploma caught their attention, and they asked why I chose to pursue a diploma instead of completing 12th grade and attempting JEE/CET. I'd advise all DSE students to prepare well for this question, as it is frequently asked in interviews.

Next, they asked about my interest in technology. I shared that I had been passionate about full stack development since my diploma days. This led to a question about my favourite project, for which I described one of my ML projects. They probed deeper into it — asking how I came up with the problem statement, the overall design, the reason behind my choice of technology, possible alternative technologies, and potential edge cases. They also asked about the challenges I faced during development.

Since my resume listed two ML projects and only one fully dedicated full stack project — and I had chosen an ML project as my favourite — they expressed concern about my fit at ISS-STOXX, as the company doesn't work extensively with AI/ML. I clarified that although the projects were ML-based, their core still relied on full stack development fundamentals — including a robust backend, scalable database, and interactive frontend. When given a hypothetical choice between working on a completely full stack project or a purely ML project at ISS, I confidently said I would choose the full stack one, as it has always been my forte and I am excited to explore the technologies ISS uses.

The interviewer knew that the last company which came before ISS-STOXX was Nomura, and asked why I couldn't clear its process. This led to questions about how many interviews I had given before, and why I thought I couldn't clear them. My suggestion to others would be to answer such questions honestly, showing self-awareness about areas of improvement and demonstrating that you have worked on them.

The interview concluded with me asking if the company organizes internal hackathons or other competitive events for employees. They replied that, at present, they do not, but expressed strong interest and agreed that it was indeed a great idea that I gave them. I added that hosting such events could enhance interaction among employees, encourage exploration of new technologies, and ultimately benefit the company.

The final results came at around 11 PM.

**Finally, 12 students got the offer !!**

### **Useful Tips:**

- Make sure that you communicate and maintain eye contact with both of the interviewers.
- Think aloud. Keep communicating your approach and your intuition on every point
- Prepare a list of few good questions before going for interviews.
- Start preparing for aptitude well before the placement drive starts as aptitude is as important as DSA
- Use Striver's A2Z DSA Sheet to prepare for interviews.
- For SQL - TOP 50 LC
- For Aptitude: use Indiabix to practice.

Feel Free to reach out: [LinkedIn](#)

**Wish You All The Very Best !!**